Week 1 — Outstanding orders and changing delivery promises

This illustrative case study uses a synthetic distribution dataset covering July–September 2026: 24 customers, 400 sales orders, 803 order lines and 784 delivery-line records. The reporting snapshot is 30 September 2026.

The initial investigation examines outstanding quantities alongside changes to promised delivery dates and the time since the latest recorded order activity.

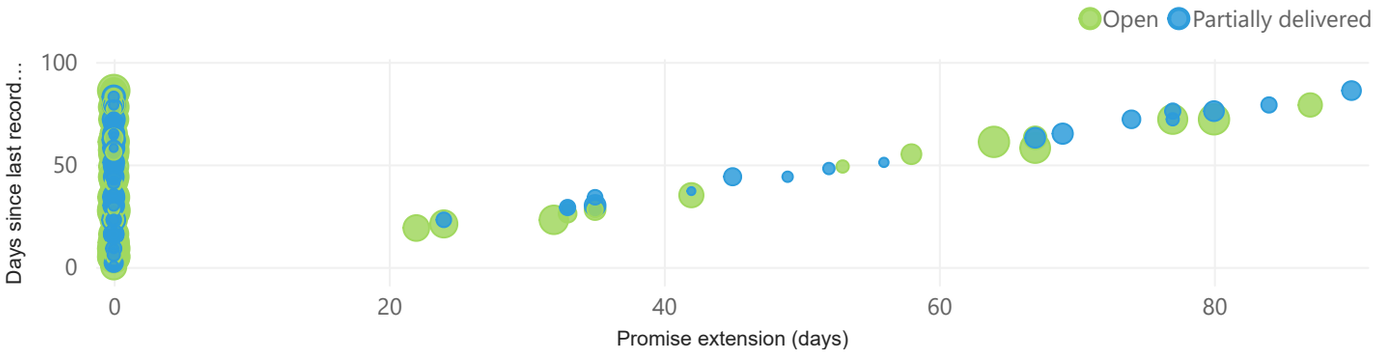
Each bubble represents one outstanding order line. Its horizontal position shows the difference between the original and current delivery promise; its vertical position shows days since the last recorded activity. Larger bubbles represent more cases outstanding.

Large promise extensions and long periods without recorded activity identify lines worth reviewing. They do not, by themselves, establish poor customer service. The next step is to understand the changes, the remaining commitments and how these exceptions are managed.

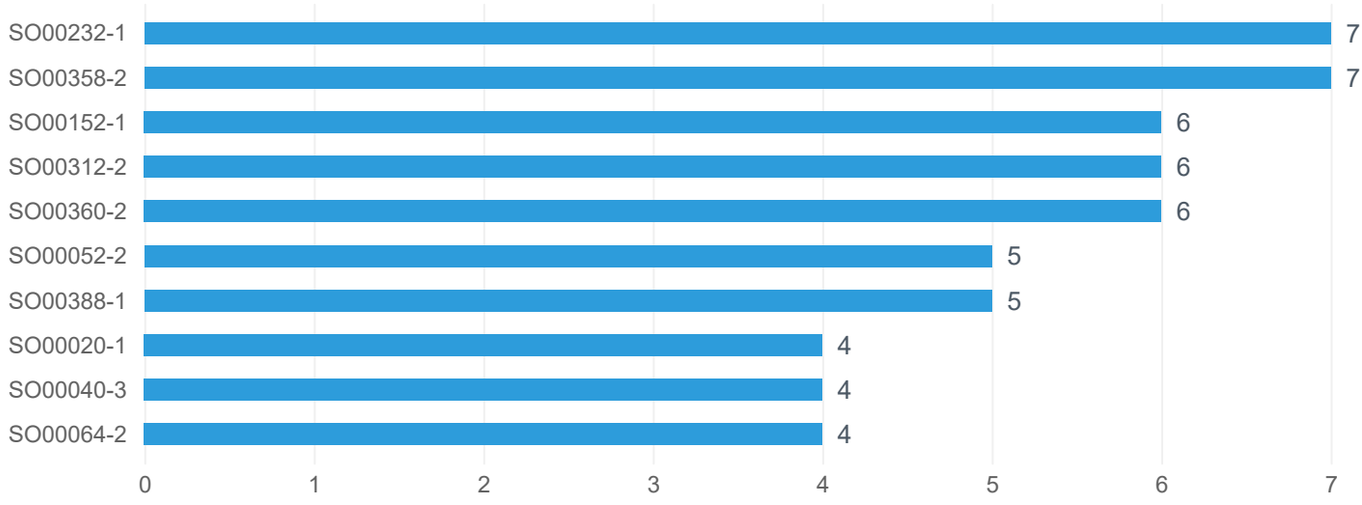
OrderLineID	Outstanding Qty	DaysOverdue	CurrentStatus	DateDifferenceOrder DateEventDate	DateDifferencePromise vsOriginalDelivery	ActivityLapse
SO00196-3	120	2	Open	11	67	63
SO00384-2	50	5	Partially delivered	10	84	79
SO00004-2	35	5	Partially delivered	7	33	29
SO00024-2	50	5	Partially delivered	7	33	29
SO00040-3	230	1	Open	7	64	61
SO00064-1	100	5	Partially delivered	7	35	30
SO00064-2	70	5	Open	7	33	26
SO00072-1	100	5	Open	7	35	28
SO00120-2	65	1	Partially delivered	7	45	44
SO00136-1	50	2	Partially delivered	7	77	76
SO00180-2	90	1	Open	7	58	55
SO00272-2	10	5	Partially delivered	7	42	37
SO00284-1	90	5	Partially delivered	7	80	76
SO00344-1	20	5	Partially delivered	7	49	44
SO00348-2	50	5	Open	7	35	28
SO00400-1	45	1	Partially delivered	7	24	23
SO00020-1	160	1	Open	6	22	19
SO00052-2	130	5	Open	6	87	79
SO00312-2	200	5	Open	6	32	23
SO00016-1	30	2	Open	5	53	49
SO00084-1	140	5	Open	5	42	35
SO00256-1	45	2	Partially delivered	5	35	34
SO00300-3	180	1	Open	5	24	21
SO00312-1	55	5	Partially delivered	5	35	30
SO00388-1	230	5	Open	5	80	72
SO00052-1	80	5	Partially delivered	4	90	86
SO00148-2	15	5	Partially delivered	4	56	51
SO00196-1	70	2	Partially delivered	4	74	72
SO00252-1	95	5	Partially delivered	3	69	65
SO00328-1	30	5	Partially delivered	3	77	72
SO00112-1	25	5	Partially delivered	2	52	48
SO00152-1	220	5	Open	1	67	58
SO00248-1	90	5	Partially delivered	1	67	63
SO00360-2	210	1	Open	1	77	72

Outstanding orders: changed promises and recorded inactivity

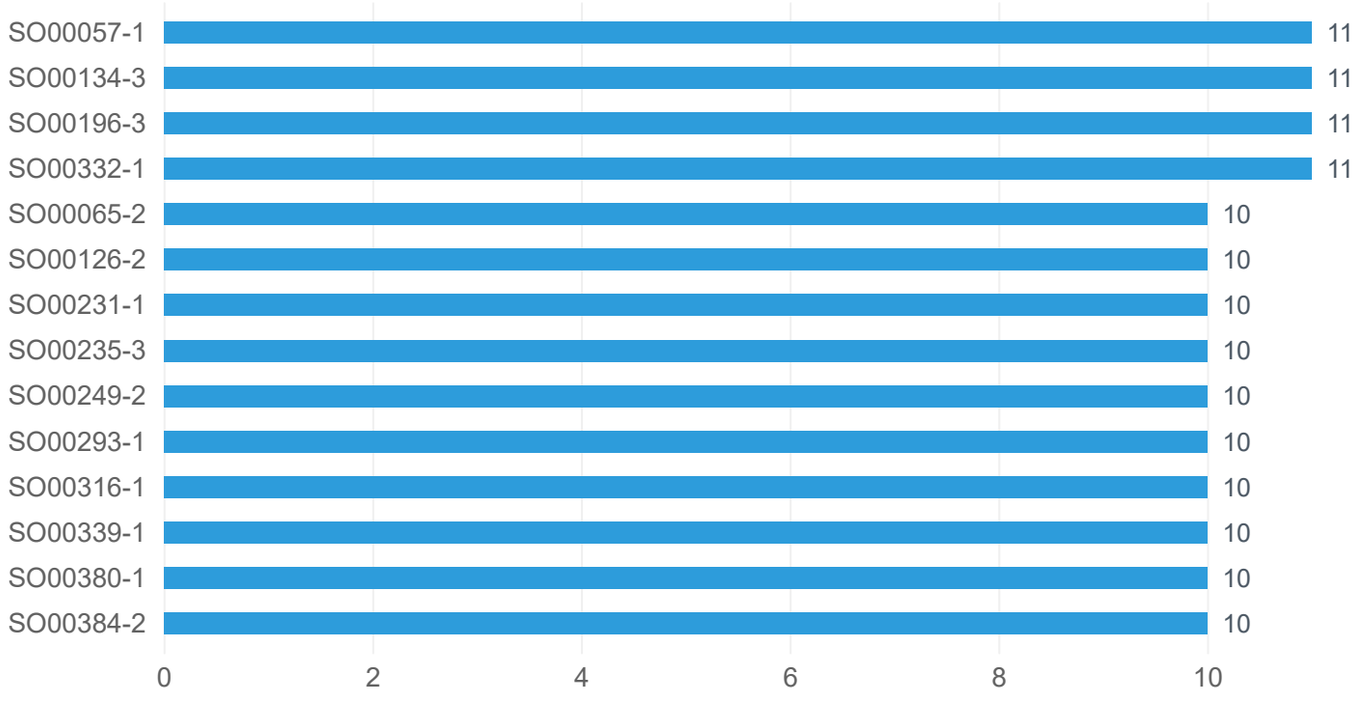
Promise extension (days), Days since last recorded activity and Outstanding Qty by OrderLineID and Current Status



Days between latest promise change and last recorded activity
by OrderLineID



Time from order creation to the latest promise change

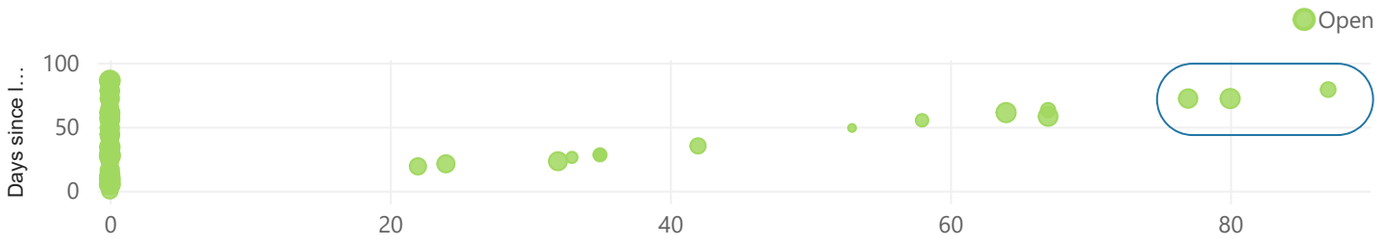


Week 2 — The delivery date has changed. What explains the change - and what needs to happen next?

We take a look at the change history of three open order lines with 72-29 days since their last recorded activity.

Outstanding orders: changed promises and recorded inactivity

Promise extension (days), Days since last recorded activity and Outstanding Qty by OrderLineID and Current Status



OrderLineID	ProductID	Order Date	Last Activity Date	Report Date	Difference Original/Current Promise (days)	Days since last activity
SO00052-2	P005	02 July 2026	13 July 2026	30 September 2026	87	79
SO00360-2	P018	13 July 2026	20 July 2026	30 September 2026	77	72
SO00388-1	P013	10 July 2026	20 July 2026	30 September 2026	80	72

OrderLineID	Event Date	Changed By Role	Reason Code	Event Type	Old Value	New Value
SO00052-2	02 July 2026	Sales administration	New order	Created		Open
SO00052-2	08 July 2026	Planning	Supply reschedule	PromiseChanged	2026-07-10	2026-10-05
SO00052-2	13 July 2026	Planning	Awaiting customer instruction	Review	Open	Open
SO00052-2	13 July 2026	System	Awaiting customer instruction	StatusChanged	Open	Open
SO00360-2	13 July 2026	Sales administration	New order	Created		Open
SO00360-2	14 July 2026	Planning	Supply reschedule	PromiseChanged	2026-07-16	2026-10-01
SO00360-2	20 July 2026	Planning	Awaiting stock	Review	Open	Open
SO00360-2	20 July 2026	System	Awaiting stock	StatusChanged	Open	Open
SO00388-1	10 July 2026	Sales administration	New order	Created		Open
SO00388-1	15 July 2026	Planning	Supply reschedule	PromiseChanged	2026-07-17	2026-10-05
SO00388-1	20 July 2026	Planning	Awaiting customer instruction	Review	Open	Open
SO00388-1	20 July 2026	System	Awaiting customer instruction	StatusChanged	Open	Open

The history records why the delivery promises changed and what each order line was waiting for at its last review. At the reporting snapshot, those entries were 72–79 days old. The next check is whether customer conversations or supply updates are recorded elsewhere, who owns the outstanding action, and when another review is due. An exception view showing the recorded reason, responsible person and next review date could help staff recognise when follow-up or escalation is needed.

Proposed actions to test:

1. **Make the supporting information traceable.** Check where customer instructions and supply updates are recorded, and provide a reference from the order line so staff can follow the latest position.
2. **Give each exception an owner and a review date.** Record who is responsible, what needs to happen next and when progress should be checked.
3. **Agree when to follow up or escalate.** Create an exception view using outstanding quantity, promise changes and review dates. Walk staff through examples so they understand which action each flag calls for.

A reason code explains the last update. Does it tell the next person what to do?